ProduceHERS 🌟 💡

Case 2: Career Navigation Platform for Early-Career Professionals

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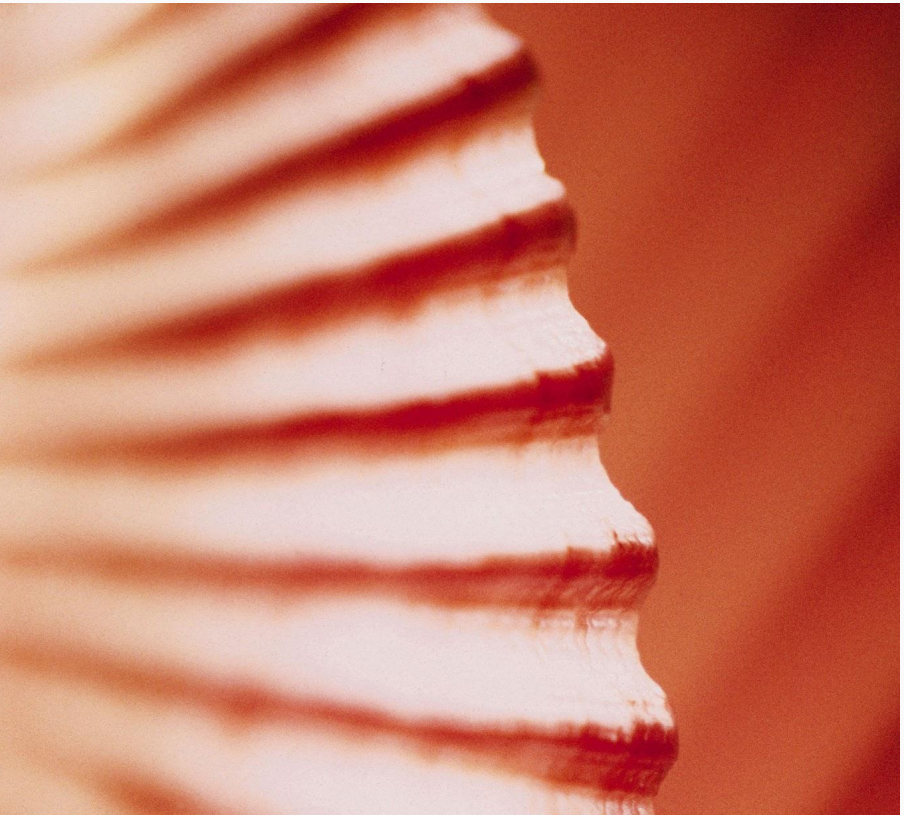
Agenda



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Our Problem Statement ?

Early-career talent feels overwhelmed and lost as they jump across scattered tools for resumes, skill-gap checks, applications, and recruiter communication, leading to **burnout** as it prevents them from confidently targeting roles and **blocking companies from discovering qualified candidates.**

At the same time, universities struggle with low post-graduation employment rates - typically around 55% within six months – because most students don't receive consistent, tech-enabled career support (NACE, 2025). Career centers are under-resourced, engagement is low, and existing tools are fragmented, leaving institutions **unable to effectively guide students into the workforce.**

Our Vision

As a platform committed to **bridging the gap** between **emerging talent** and **employers**, we strive to ensure that qualified candidates are seen, understood, and supported throughout the hiring journey.

To achieve this vision, we focus on **empowering job seekers** with **clarity** across the most critical parts of the application process:

- Which version of their resume best aligns with which role
- Whether they are truly ready for specific companies or roles
- What skill gaps prevent them from passing technical and behavioral interviews
- How to prioritize preparation effectively

Existing Tools

As students in career-focused programs, we are all familiar with the stack of platforms we use to navigate job search.

Early-career professionals rely on multiple platforms to manage job discovery, preparation, and tracking.

But these tools operate in silos — creating **cognitive overload** instead of clarity.

Job Boards

Jobs | Date posted | Experience level | Company | Job type | On-site/remote | Easy Apply | All filters

Content Management Associate
Preqin
London, England, United Kingdom (Hybrid)
You have a preferred skill badge
2 days ago · Easy Apply

Marketing Content Specialist
X-POLE
Potters Bar, England, United Kingdom (Hybrid)
You have a preferred skill badge
6 days ago · Easy Apply

Content Marketing Executive
Activate Group Limited
Halifax, England, United Kingdom (Hybrid)
Actively recruiting
4 days ago · 18 applicants

Senior Content Marketing Executive
NRG.
Newcastle upon Tyne, England, United Kingdom (Hybrid)
You have a preferred skill badge

Preqin · London, England, United Kingdom (Hybrid) 2 days ago · 168 applicants

Full-time · Entry level
1,001-5,000 employees · Financial Services
2 school alumni
You have a preferred skill badge

Easy Apply | Save

Meet the hiring team

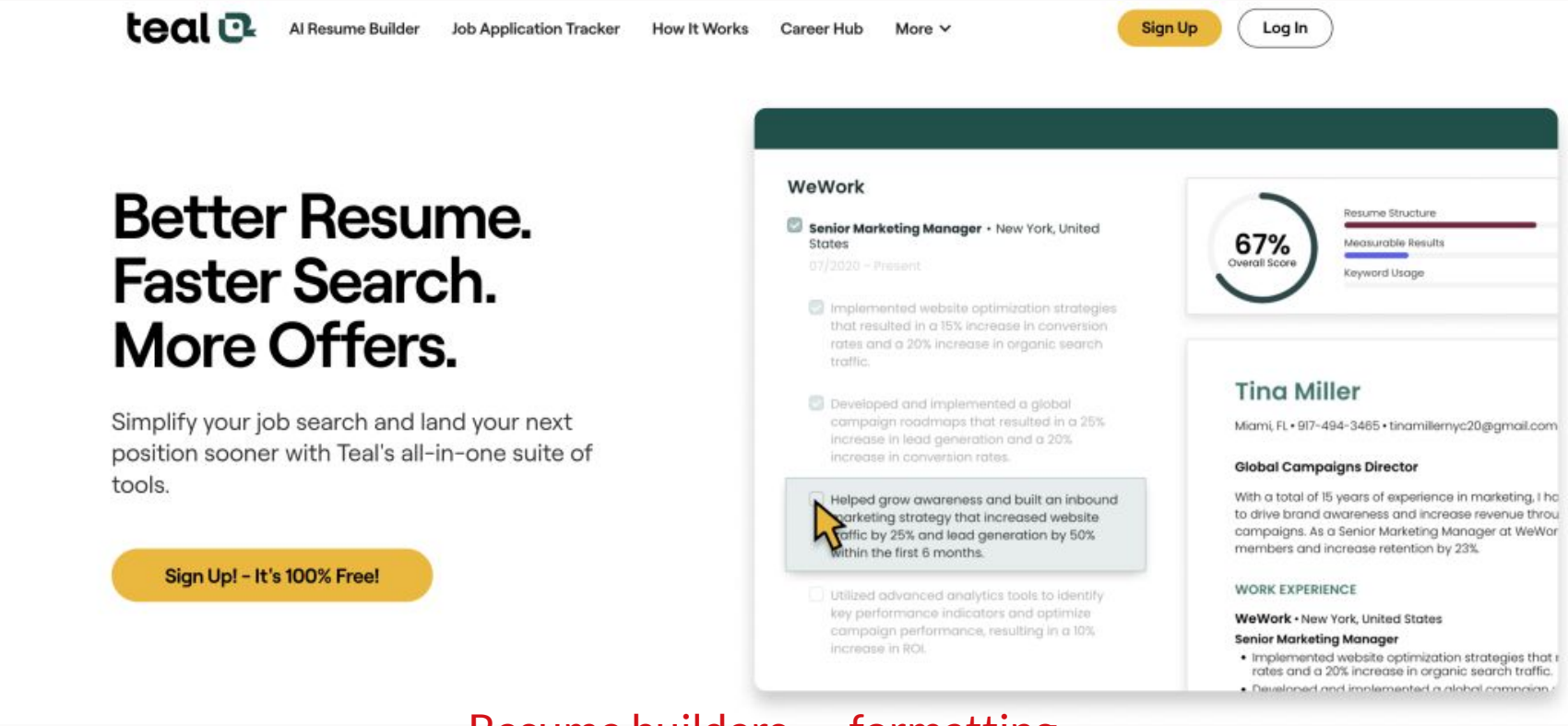
Jeanie Chang , IHRP-CP · 2nd
Senior Talent Acquisition Specialist (APAC) at Preqin
Job poster
1 mutual connection
Message

About Preqin
You will be joining the world's leading data and insights provider for the alternative assets market. We empower the global financial community with critical information and l analytics solutions to help them make faster and smarter investment decisions, and

Messa

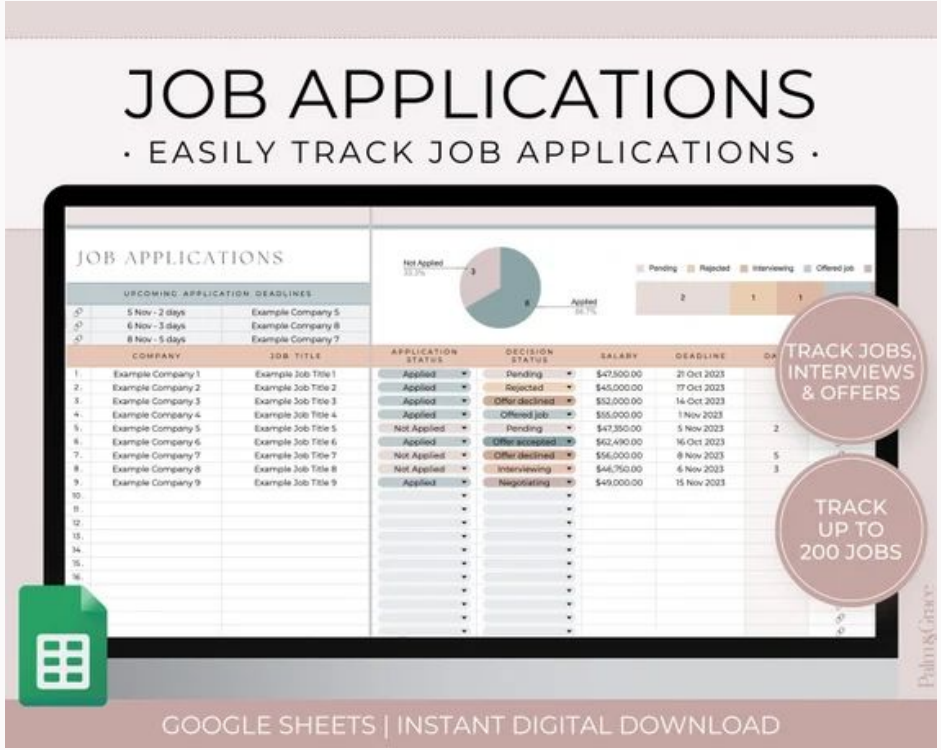
LinkedIn → job discovery

Resume Builder



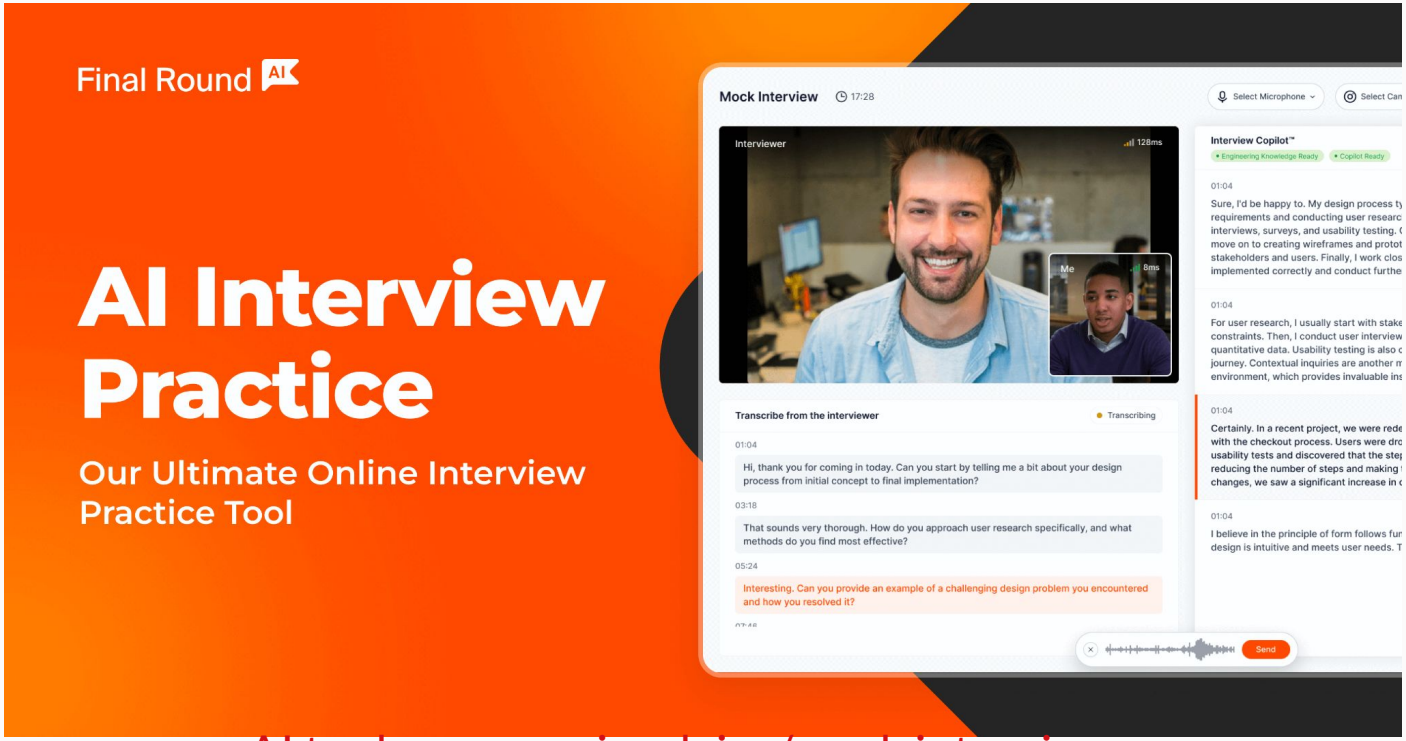
Resume builders → formatting

Application Tracker



Spreadsheets → tracking

AI Tools



AI tools → generic advice/mock interviews

However...

There is no unified system that fully connects:

Phase 01
Job Requirements

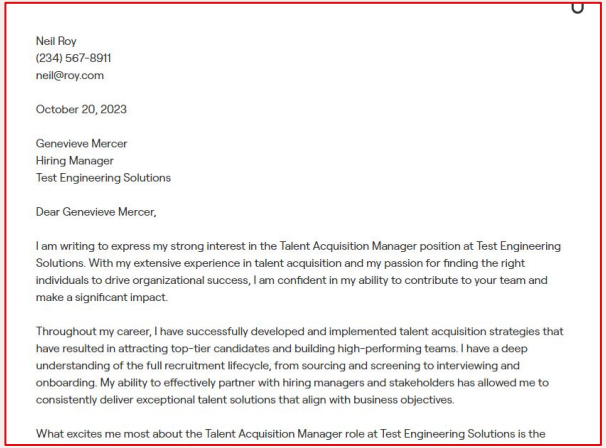
Phase 02
Skill Gaps

Phase 03
Company Expectations

Phase 04
Targeted Preparation

Phase 05
Application Tracking

As Hiring Managers, you also have struggles...



Neil Roy
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neil@roy.com

October 20, 2023

Genevieve Mercer
Hiring Manager
Test Engineering Solutions

Dear Genevieve Mercer,

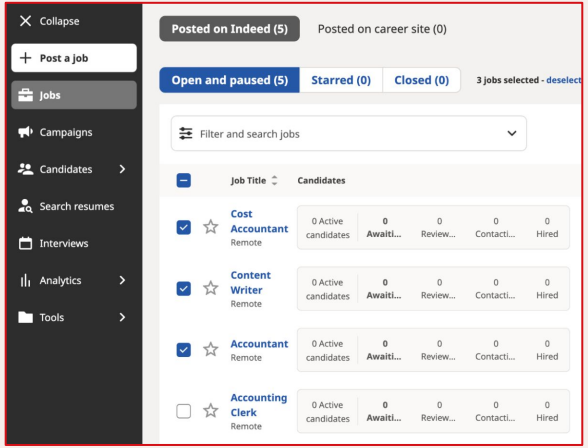
I am writing to express my strong interest in the Talent Acquisition Manager position at Test Engineering Solutions. With my extensive experience in talent acquisition and my passion for finding the right individuals to drive organizational success, I am confident in my ability to contribute to your team and make a significant impact.

Throughout my career, I have successfully developed and implemented talent acquisition strategies that have resulted in attracting top-tier candidates and building high-performing teams. I have a deep understanding of the full recruitment lifecycle, from sourcing and screening to interviewing and onboarding. My ability to effectively partner with hiring managers and stakeholders has allowed me to consistently deliver exceptional talent solutions that align with business objectives.

What excites me most about the Talent Acquisition Manager role at Test Engineering Solutions is the

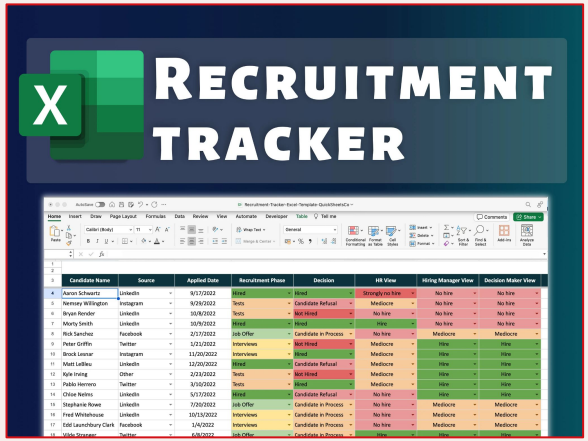
Respond to cold emails and LinkedIn messages

Hiring managers must sift through and respond to a constant stream of cold emails and LinkedIn messages from candidates, often across multiple platforms, making it difficult to prioritize serious, qualified applicants.



Post jobs across multiple platforms

Hiring managers must post the same job opening across multiple platforms (from company career pages to LinkedIn and university portals) increasing administrative effort and fragmentation.



Manually track candidates in spreadsheets

Recruiters often rely on manual spreadsheets to track candidates, interview stages, and hiring decisions, increasing administrative workload and the risk of errors.

Market Opportunity

15-16M

undergraduate students in the US (AAU, 2025)

2M

undergraduate graduates per year, and rising (Statista, 2025)

20%

receive high-quality, tech-enabled education-to-career coaching (Mowreader, 2024)

Opportunity: A large, underserved market ready for a modern platform that bridges the gap between students and employers while improving post-grad success at scale.

***Higher**: A Unified Hiring Ecosystem for Universities*

We help **students** apply **strategically** and help **recruiters** screen with **clarity**. **Bridging the gap** in one centralized platform.

1. **Centralized Workflow**

   All job discovery, resume alignment, preparation, and application tracking in one system.

2. **Structured Readiness Alignment**

   Students prepare based on company-defined expectations before applying.

3. **Transparent Communication & Status**

   Reduced ghosting through structured status updates and centralized messaging.

However, our model operates under several key assumptions that must hold true for long-term success.

Student Assumptions

- Students are willing to engage in structured preparation before applying.
- Students value readiness scoring over high-volume application strategies.
- Students are comfortable managing resumes and preparation within one integrated platform.
- Students trust AI-driven skill gap diagnostics.

University Assumptions

- Universities are incentivized to improve employment placement metrics.
- Universities are willing to license hiring infrastructure tools.
- Career centers are open to structured employer alignment systems.
- Universities can onboard partner employers into a centralized platform.

Employer Assumptions

- Employers value pre-aligned, better-prepared candidates.
- Employers are willing to upload competency frameworks or evaluation criteria.
- Employers prefer structured campus hiring workflows over scattered outreach.
- Transparent status updates reduce inbound candidate noise.

Our Product

Our platform brings students and employers closer by creating a shared, AI-powered space for communication, preparation, and hiring. We simplify the entire job application process for students and streamline early-talent recruiting for employers – giving universities a modern, unified solution that improves placement outcomes and strengthens employer partnerships.

Students	Employers	Universities
• Auto-filled applications & centralized tracking • Tailored resume & interview prep • Clear guidance that reduces stress and saves time	• Centralized early-talent pipeline • AI-matched candidates • Integrated messaging & ATS friendly workflows	• Higher student placement rates • Stronger employer partnerships • Unified, AI-driven career platform

1. Resume Intelligence Dashboard

- Automatically matches saved jobs to best-fit resume
- Displays readiness match %
- Suggests when to tailor before applying
- Clusters jobs by career interest

Outcome: Smarter applications, not more applications.

2. Application Transparency Tracker

- Tracks status (Applied → Interview → Offer → Rejected)
- Structured updates from HR
- Interview scheduling within platform
- Clear movement between stages

Outcome: Reduced ghosting and clearer pipeline visibility.

3. AI Preparation Agent

- Maps job requirements to company competency frameworks
- Identifies skill gaps
- Provides targeted mock interviews
- Updates readiness score dynamically

Outcome: Preparation aligned to employer expectations.

Prototype

Link to Access Prototype:
https://www.figma.com/proto/yweQ7blyEIQFDbI4ZYIVZV/Untitled?node-id=0-1&t=1rmk3ExUW74RBHUI-1

Success Metrics

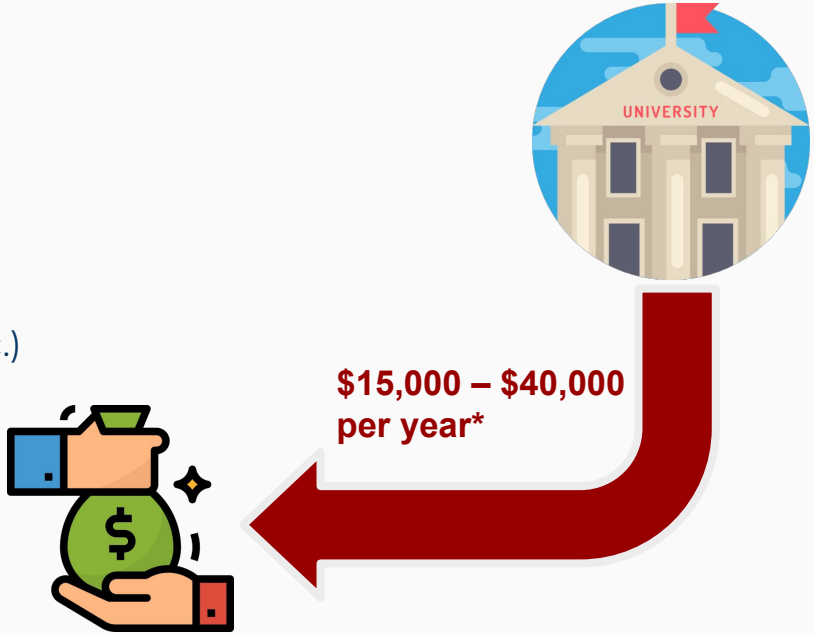
	Leading Metrics	Lagging Metrics
Student	• Increase in student logins and active usage • Growth in AI-generated resumes and job searches • Higher application completion rates • More student-employer messages and interactions • More tailored applications submitted per student	• **8-12%** increase in post-graduate employment rates • **25-35%** increase in internships and job offers • Higher interview-to-offer conversation rates
Employer	• Increase in employer sign-ups and active recruiters • More job postings • Higher engagement with student profiles • Growth in employer-student messaging	• Faster time-to-hire for early-career roles • Higher quality of applicants • Increased retention of early-career hires
University	• Higher student engagement with career services • Increased employer partnerships initiated through the platform	• Improved overall placement outcomes • Stronger long-term employer partnerships • Higher student satisfaction with career support

Revenue Model

We operate a B2B-first SaaS model where universities purchase the platform, students access it for free, and additional revenue comes from optional student upgrades and premium employer tools.

Primary Revenue Stream - Universities (B2B SaaS)

- Annual institutional platform license
- Pricing tiered by student population
- Optional premium add-ons:
  - AI interview prep
  - Advanced analytics for career centers
  - CRM integrations (Handshake, Symplicity, etc.)
  - Resume benchmarking dashboards



(*)Estimated using benchmark pricing from comparable university career platforms (Handshake, VMock, Symplicity).

Revenue Model

Secondary Revenue Streams

1. Students (B2C Premium Upgrades)

- Personalized AI interview coaching
- Unlimited resume tailoring
- Multi-role resume versions
- Priority recruiter visibility

2. Employers (B2B2C Talent Tools)

- Candidate matching & recommendations
- Recruiter messaging & talent search
- Job posting packages

Thank you

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